

Understanding Your Medicare Options

Medicare can feel like a maze of letters and deadlines. This page breaks down the basics — no sales pitch, just plain-language education so you know what questions to ask.

THE PARTS OF MEDICARE

Part A	Hospital insurance — inpatient stays, skilled nursing, hospice, some home health.
Part B	Medical insurance — doctor visits, outpatient care, preventive services, durable medical equipment.
Part C	Medicare Advantage — an alternative way to get A & B (often with extra benefits) through a private, Medicare-approved plan.
Part D	Prescription drug coverage — offered through private plans, either stand-alone or bundled into a Part C plan.
Medigap	Optional supplement insurance that helps cover out-of-pocket costs left by Original Medicare (Parts A & B).

KEY ENROLLMENT PERIODS

- **Initial Enrollment Period:** A 7-month window around your 65th birthday to sign up for the first time.
- **Annual Enrollment Period (AEP):** October 15 – December 7 each year. You can switch, join, or drop plans for the following year.
- **Medicare Advantage Open Enrollment:** January 1 – March 31. One plan switch allowed if you're already in a Medicare Advantage plan.

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING EVERY YEAR

- **Provider network:** Are my doctors and pharmacy still in-network for next year?
- **Drug formulary:** Are my medications still covered, and at what tier?
- **Costs:** Has my premium, deductible, or out-of-pocket maximum changed?
- **Extra benefits:** Am I using everything available to me — dental, vision, hearing, fitness, etc.?

WHY TALK TO A LICENSED AGENT

A licensed, independent agent can compare options across multiple carriers at no cost to you, explain how changes affect your specific situation, and help you avoid gaps in coverage. There's never an obligation to enroll through any conversation.

Medicare plans change every year — premiums, drug coverage, and provider networks can shift without you noticing. I help people in Richmond and Fort Bend County make sense of it, at no cost to you.

- ✓ Licensed, local Medicare insurance agent
- ✓ I represent multiple carriers — not just one company
- ✓ No-cost, no-obligation plan review
- ✓ Available now through December 7th

This is an educational overview, not an offer or endorsement of any specific plan. We do not offer every plan available in your area. Any information we provide is limited to those plans we do offer in your area. Please contact Medicare.gov, 1-800-MEDICARE, or your local State Health Insurance Program (SHIP) to get information on all of your options.

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